



PATIENT GUIDE

LASIK

Understanding, managing and treating:
A complete guide for patients of Samyak Drishti Eye Clinic



Contact

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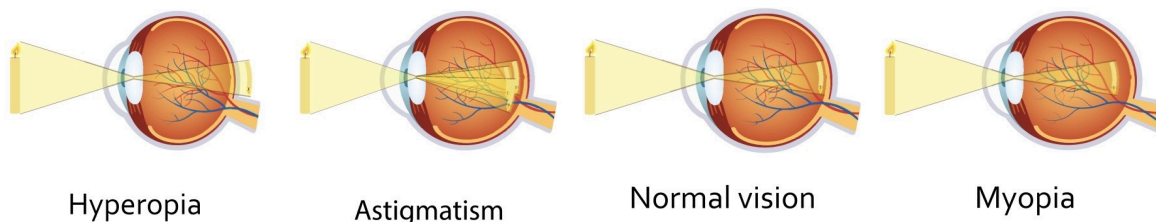
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WHAT ARE REFRACTIVE ERRORS?

The eye works like a camera. For clear vision, light entering the eye must focus precisely on the retina at the back. When the shape of the eye prevents this from happening, the result is a refractive error, and vision becomes blurred or distorted.

There are three common types:

- Myopia (nearsightedness) – difficulty seeing objects at a distance
- Hyperopia (farsightedness) – difficulty focusing on near objects
- Astigmatism – blurred or distorted vision caused by an irregular corneal shape



WHAT IS LASIK?

LASIK (Laser-Assisted In Situ Keratomileusis) is a precise laser procedure that permanently reshapes the cornea – the clear front surface of the eye – to correct your spectacle number. By changing the curvature of the cornea, light entering the eye is refocused sharply on the retina, giving you clear, unaided vision.

Why Us?

Dr. Sujal Shah is India's first fellowship-trained refractive surgeon, with over 30 years of experience and more than 50,000 refractive surgeries performed since 1996.

Did you know?

Approximately 700,000 LASIK procedures are performed in India every year. Clinical studies consistently show that of patients achieve 6/12 vision or better after LASIK – the standard required for driving without correction.

ARE YOU A CANDIDATE FOR LASIK?

Suitability for LASIK can only be confirmed after a thorough personal examination. In general, good candidates:

- Are ideally 21 years of age or older, when the prescription is more likely to have fully stabilised (minimum 18, with no change in the past 12 months)
- Have healthy corneas of adequate thickness
- Have a prescription within the treatable range
- Are not pregnant or breastfeeding

Who Should NOT Have LASIK?

Certain conditions may make you unsuitable for LASIK. These include:

- A prescription that is still changing year on year
- Corneas that are not suitable, for example, too thin, scarred, or diseased
- Keratoconus or early keratoconus
- A cataract that is affecting vision

If any of these apply to you, Dr Sujal or Dr Manisha will explain why LASIK may not be appropriate and discuss the alternatives available to you.

Why Trust Matters

Dr. Sujal Shah has undergone LASIK himself. He has also performed LASIK on his own spouse, a fellow LASIK surgeon. It's why ophthalmologists and doctors trust Samyak Drishti for their own vision correction.

Your Pre-Operative Consultation

Your LASIK consultation at Samyak Drishti is a comprehensive, multiparametric evaluation. It includes:



Visual acuity assessment – measuring how clearly you see at distance and near

Corneal topography – screen for irregularities and maps the corneal surface to plan Topography-Guided LASIK and

Corneal tomography (Pentacam) – measures both corneal surfaces; the most important test to confirm long-term LASIK safety and rule out keratoconus

Corneal Biomechanics Testing–Using a gentle air puff, devices like the Corvis ST measure how the cornea responds to pressure, with parameters such as corneal stiffness and deformation.

Pachymetry – measures corneal thickness to determine how much correction can safely be achieved

Wavefront analysis (WASCA) – maps hundreds of individual optical imperfections in the eye to enable fully customised treatment

Biometry – measures corneal shape, size, anterior chamber depth, and pupil dimensions

Note: When corneal tomography and biomechanics testing are used together, they provide a far more complete picture than either test alone, catching what one would miss without the other.

Why Us?

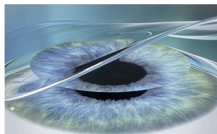
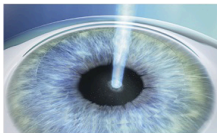
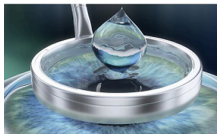
Samyak Drishti is one of only three centres in Mumbai with corneal biomechanics technology (Corvis ST), and the only one with both excimer and femtosecond lasers under one roof, enabling truly personalised, all-laser vision correction.

YOUR VISION CORRECTION PROCEDURE OPTIONS

Laser vision correction is not a single procedure. It is a family of techniques, each suited to different corneal profiles, prescriptions, and lifestyles. At Samya Drishti, the decision of which procedure is right for you is made after a thorough diagnostic assessment. All procedures use the Carl Zeiss Meditec platform.

There are three core procedures. Each can be further personalised based on your corneal data and visual goals.

1

PRK | Advanced Surface Ablation (TransPRK)*No flap. No blade. No suction. Entirely laser-based.***1a | Wavefront-Optimized (WFO) PRK**

The MEL 90 excimer laser removes the epithelium and reshapes the cornea in a single, uninterrupted step. The epithelial cells grow back naturally over 3 to 5 days. A protective contact lens is worn while healing occurs.

PRK delivers the strongest corneal biomechanical stability of all three procedures, making it the preferred option for thin corneas, higher prescriptions, and patients requiring maximum long-term safety. Recovery is slower than LASIK or SMILE.

The standard approach for regular corneas. Corrects myopia, hyperopia, and astigmatism while minimising the introduction of new higher-order aberrations that can affect night vision quality.

Advantages

- ✓ No flap, blade, or suction of any kind
- ✓ Strongest corneal structural stability after surgery
- ✓ Ideal for thin corneas or borderline candidates
- ✓ Excellent long-term safety and proven track record

1b | Topography-Guided PRK

For corneas with surface irregularities, complex astigmatism, or previous laser surgery. Thousands of data points from your corneal topography map guide a treatment that smooths irregularities and improves visual quality beyond what WFO can achieve.

Advantages

- ✓ Corrects corneal surface irregularities in addition to the prescription
- ✓ Induces fewer higher-order aberrations than WFO
- ✓ Preferred for re-treatment or irregular corneas

1c | Presbyond Laser Blended Vision PRK

For patients over 40 who wish to reduce dependence on reading glasses. The dominant eye is corrected for distance; the non-dominant eye is set for near. A wavefront-optimized ablation profile creates a blend zone in each eye, allowing the brain to merge both images into continuous vision at all distances.

Dr. Sujal Shah was the first surgeon in India to perform Presbyond Laser Blended Vision

Advantages

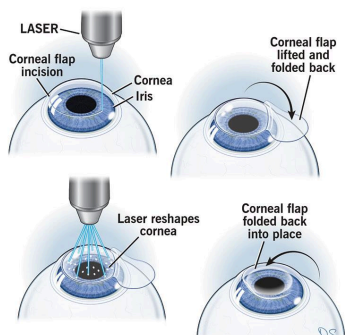
- ✓ Distance, intermediate, and near vision corrected in a single procedure
- ✓ Suitable for myopia, hyperopia, and astigmatism
- ✓ More natural vision range than traditional monovision
- ✓ Reversible if needed

Note: Recovery for PRK is longer than LASIK or SMILE. Expect mild discomfort and fluctuating vision for the first 2 to 3 days, with good functional vision returning within 1 to 2 weeks. Final results are comparable to LASIK.

2

LASIK | Femto-LASIK (Bladeless)

All-laser. No blade ever touches the eye.



Modern LASIK uses a femtosecond laser to create the corneal flap, replacing the older mechanical blade. Samyak Drishti was the first centre in Mumbai to offer VisuMax Femto-LASIK.

Step 1: The VisuMax femtosecond laser creates a customised corneal flap in approximately 20 seconds. Flap dimensions are individually programmed for each eye.

Step 2: The MEL 90 excimer laser reshapes the cornea according to your personalised treatment plan.

Step 3: The flap is gently repositioned and adheres naturally without stitches. Most patients see well by the following morning.

When the suction ring is applied during flap creation, your vision may briefly dim for a few seconds. This is completely normal and temporary.

2a | Wavefront-Optimized (WFO) Femto-LASIK

The standard approach for regular corneas. An advanced ablation profile adds extra pulses at the corneal periphery to minimise the induction of new higher-order aberrations, protecting night vision quality.

Advantages

- ✓ Completely bladeless with custom flap dimensions
- ✓ Fastest visual recovery of all procedures
- ✓ Rapid return to normal activities
- ✓ Proven safety and predictability

2b | Topography-Guided Femto-LASIK

For corneas with surface irregularities, complex astigmatism, or where superior visual quality is the priority. Corneal topography data is imported directly into the treatment plan via CRS Master software to smooth irregularities and reduce aberrations.

Advantages

- ✓ Corrects surface irregularities beyond the prescription
- ✓ Induces fewer higher-order aberrations than WFO LASIK
- ✓ Preferred for complex astigmatism or prior unsatisfactory LASIK

TOPOLINE LASIK(Topograph y-Guided)

Corneal topography maps thousands of data points across the corneal surface. This map is imported into CRS Master to plan a treatment that smooths corneal irregularities and improves visual quality. Excellent for irregular corneas or prior unsatisfactory LASIK.

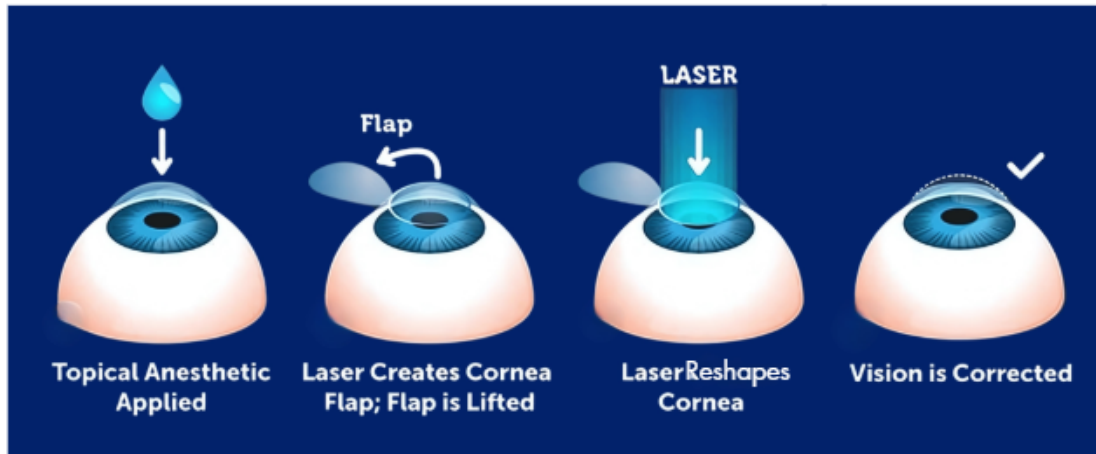
2c | Presbyond Laser Blended Vision LASIK

The same Presbyond principle as described under PRK, delivered via the Femto-LASIK platform. Clinical studies confirm it is a safe and effective treatment for both myopic and hyperopic presbyopia, with high patient satisfaction and no loss of contrast sensitivity.

Advantages

- ✓ Glasses-free vision at all distances for the vast majority of daily tasks
- ✓ Suitable for myopia, hyperopia, and astigmatism

- ✓ Reversible if needed
- ✓ Same rapid recovery as standard Femto-LASIK



3

SMILE | Small Incision Lenticule Extraction

Flapless. Bladeless. Single laser.

SMILE is the most recent generation of laser vision correction and uses a single femtosecond laser with no excimer laser and no flap.

Step 1: The VisuMax femtosecond laser creates a precisely shaped disc of corneal tissue (a lenticule) and a small incision under 4 mm, entirely within the intact cornea, in under 30 seconds.

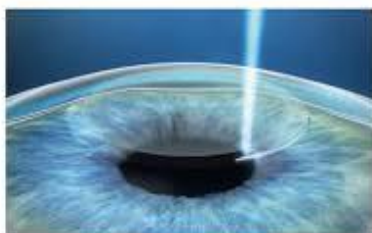
Step 2: The surgeon gently removes the lenticule through the keyhole incision. This changes the corneal curvature and corrects the refractive error.

There is no flap and the corneal surface remains almost entirely undisturbed. Studies show a lower reduction and faster recovery of corneal sensation compared to LASIK, and better preservation of corneal biomechanical strength. SMILE treats myopia up to -10D and astigmatism up to -5D.

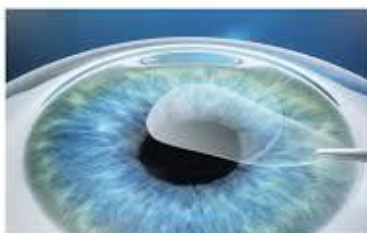
Samyak Drishti was the first centre in India, and 27th in the world, to offer SMILE.

Advantages

- ✓ Flapless: no risk of flap-related complications
- ✓ Minimal incision under 4 mm preserves corneal strength
- ✓ Significantly lower risk of dry eye compared to LASIK
- ✓ Ideal for active lifestyles and contact sports
- ✓ Faster healing with minimal post-operative precautions



1. Lenticule made



2. Lenticule removed



3. Corrected refractive error

About Samyak Drishti

Samyak Drishti was the 27th SMILE site in the world and the first in India to offer SMILE commercially, 6 months before global launch.

Procedures at a Glance

Feature	Standard LASIK	Femto-LASIK	SMILE	ASA / TransPRK
Flap	Yes (blade)	Yes (laser)	No flap	No flap
Incision	~20 mm	~20 mm	< 4 mm	7 mm
Dry eye risk	Moderate	Moderate	Lowest	Low
Recovery	Next day	Next day	Next day	1-2 weeks
Thin cornea	Limited	Limited	Better	Yes
Active / sports	Caution	Caution	Ideal	Ideal
Customization	SHigh	Highest	Standard	High

WHAT TO EXPECT: BEFORE, DURING & AFTER SURGERY

Before Surgery

- Stop wearing soft contact lenses at least 3 days before your pre-operative evaluation; rigid gas-permeable (RGP) lenses must be discontinued for 3–4 weeks.
- Do not apply eye makeup, creams, or perfumes on the day of surgery as the equipment used for LASIK and PRK gets affected
- Eat a light meal before your procedure – there is no fasting requirement as topical anaesthetic eye drops are used.
- Arrange transport; you will not be able to drive home on the day of surgery.

On the Day of Surgery

- Please arrive 30 minutes before your scheduled time of surgery.
- Please bring one responsible adult with you.
- Your eyes will be checked and number re-evaluated once before moving you to the OT.
- Numbing drops are instilled; an eyelid holder gently keeps the eye open – no voluntary blinking needed.
- For LASIK / Femto-LASIK: when the suction ring is applied, you may feel mild pressure and your vision may briefly go dim or black for a few seconds – this is normal and temporary.
- For SMILE: the procedure is exceptionally gentle – most patients report almost no sensation at all.
- The laser treatment itself takes 3–5 minutes per eye. Total time at the clinic is approximately 2–3 hours.
- After surgery, rest briefly and keep your eyes closed for 4–5 hours after returning home.

After Surgery – Recovery

For LASIK and Femto-LASIK:

- Vision improves dramatically within hours; most patients return to work the next day.
- Mild grittiness, watering, and light sensitivity are normal for the first 24–48 hours.
- Antibiotic and anti-inflammatory drops are prescribed – follow the tapering schedule carefully.
- Do not rub the eyes for at least one week.

For SMILE (even fewer precautions):

- Most restrictions can be discontinued the day after surgery, including face washing, driving, and light sports.

- Vision clears progressively over 6–12 weeks.

For ASA / TransPRK:

- Expect irritation and fluctuating vision for 3–5 days while the surface heals.
- Protective contact lenses are worn for approximately 4–5 days.
- Good, stable vision typically returns within 1–2 weeks; final results settle over 4–6 weeks.

Glasses after surgery:

Glasses are generally not needed after LASIK or SMILE for distance vision. If you are over 40 and did not have Presbyond, you may need reading glasses for near tasks.

POST-OPERATIVE CARE INSTRUCTIONS

Following these guidelines will help ensure the best possible outcome from your surgery:

You CAN:



Resume your regular diet and medication schedule immediately after surgery (after a few hours in case of sedation or general anaesthesia)



Watch TV and use your phone from the evening of surgery



Shower or bathe below the neck from the day after surgery.



Resume office work, reading, and screen use the next day (Note: For PRK procedure, this increases to 3-4 days)



Wear sunglasses outdoors in bright light



Drive once your surgeon confirms adequate vision at your first post-op review

You should AVOID:



Touching, rubbing, or pressing on the operated eye for at least 1 week



Water, soap, or shampoo to enter the eye for 1 week



Heavy lifting or strenuous exercise for at least 1 week



Swimming, hot tubs, saunas, steam rooms or contact sports (tennis, badminton etc.) for at least 2 weeks



Eye makeup and eyeliner for 2 weeks (to prevent infection)



Dusty or smoky environments; wear sunglasses outdoors in bright light

RISKS & SIDE EFFECTS

LASIK and its variants are extremely safe. Serious complications are rare. Like any surgical procedure, risks exist and will be discussed fully during your consultation.

Possible Complications – Contact Us Immediately If You Notice:

- Moderate to severe eye pain (mild grittiness in the first day or two is normal)
- Significant decrease in vision
- Increasing redness, discharge, or swelling
- Sudden new floaters, flashes of light, or a shadow across your vision

Common, Temporary Side Effects

- Dry eyes – the most common side effect, usually resolving within a few weeks to months; more common after LASIK than SMILE. Patients with pre-existing dry eye are at higher risk of chronic dry eye after surgery.
- Glare and halos around lights at night – generally settles within weeks to months.
- Mild under- or over-correction – in a small percentage of patients, a touch-up enhancement may be recommended after 3 months.
- Visual fluctuation – particularly in the first few weeks; vision sharpens progressively.

Enhancement Procedures

If vision is not fully corrected after your primary procedure, or if there is some regression over time, an enhancement can be performed after a minimum of 3 months. At Samyak Drishti, LASIK enhancements are also used to fine-tune vision after cataract surgery with premium IOLs.

HOW LONG WILL THE RESULTS LAST?

The effects of LASIK are permanent. The corneal reshaping does not reverse. However, your eyes can still change with age – just as they would have done with or without LASIK:

- Eyes can develop presbyopia after 40, requiring reading glasses regardless of LASIK (unless Presbyond was performed).
 - Cataracts may develop with age; these are treated with cataract surgery independently of prior LASIK.
 - A small shift in prescription may occur over many years; enhancement is available if needed.
-

CONTACT & APPOINTMENTS

Book Your Cataract Assessment

Don't let discomfort become your normal.

At Samyak Drishti, you will receive a thorough tear film evaluation, a clear diagnosis, and a personalised treatment plan suited to your lifestyle and needs.

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www.samyakdrishti.com

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Clear Vision. Better Life.

This guide is intended for patient education only and does not replace personalised medical advice.

Always consult Dr. Sujal Shah or Dr. Manisha Shah for guidance specific to your eyes and health.